

Ashish Adhikari

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EDUCATION

The Ohio State University, Columbus, OH, USA Expected 2027
Ph.D. in Agricultural, Environmental, and Development Economics

University of Georgia, Athens, GA, USA 2020–2022
M.S. in Agricultural and Applied Economics

Agriculture and Forestry University, Rampur, Chitwan, Nepal 2013–2018
B.Sc. in Agriculture

FIELDS OF RESEARCH

Primary Development Economics
Secondary International Trade in Agriculture; Agricultural Economics

WORKING PAPERS

1. “Hidden Inequalities: Impact of Son Preference in Fertility Outcomes and Child Health in South Asia” *with Leah Bevis*.
2. “Planting, Harvest, and Hope: Agricultural Production and Migration Aspirations” *with Tom Whittington and Alexis Villacis*. Under review.
3. “Does Trade Stabilize Food Prices Evenly During a Supply Shock? Evidence from India’s Pulses Market” *with Ian Sheldon*.
4. “Irrigation in Transition: Changing Patterns of Groundwater Use in Nepal” *with Leah Bevis, Avinash Kishore, and Anton Urfels*. Under review.

WORK IN PROGRESS

1. “Does Political Reservation Affect Program Implementation? Evidence from India”
2. “Political Power and Public Health: Examining the Effects of Low-Caste Representation on Child Health in India” *with Karan Shakya and Jongeun Park*.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Graduate Research Associate August 2022 – August 2025
Department of Agricultural, Environmental, and Development Economics, The Ohio State University

Graduate Research Assistant August 2020 – May 2022
Department of Agricultural and Applied Economics, University of Georgia

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Lead Instructor

January 2026 – May 2026

Data Analysis for Agribusiness and Applied Economics (AEDE 2005), The Ohio State University

- Independently designed and taught the course, including lectures and exams, to 14 undergraduate students.
- Student evaluation: 4.75/5.0 overall; 9.6/10 teaching effectiveness.

Lab Instructor

August 2025 – December 2025

Data Analysis for Agribusiness and Applied Economics (AEDE 2005), The Ohio State University

- Led lab sessions on data management and statistical analysis in Excel for 36 undergraduate students.
- Student evaluation: 4.79/5.0 overall; 9.3/10 teaching effectiveness.

Graduate Teaching Assistant

August 2021 – December 2021

Intermediate Economic Principles (AAEC 3580), University of Georgia

- Led weekly recitation sessions on intermediate microeconomics for 48 undergraduate students.

Instructor

April 2019 – December 2020

Agricultural Economics, Shree Tribhuvan Model Secondary School, Nepal

- Taught agricultural economics to secondary students (grades 9–12); developed lesson plans and applied real-world examples.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Research Associate

June 2025

Inclusion Economics India Centre

- Conducted scoping work in 4 districts in Bihar on the convergence of MGNREGA and JEEVIKA programs.

Communications Coordinator

August 2021 – August 2022

Agricultural and Applied Economics Association, International Section

- Coordinated communications and outreach to strengthen member engagement and the section's visibility across the international agricultural economics community.

Assistant Agriculture Officer

June 2018 – December 2018

Nature's Conservation Private Limited, Kathmandu, Nepal

- Conducted field visits across 18 communities, leading focus groups and rural appraisals to prepare a climate change adaptation strategy for sustainable agriculture.

Research Intern

December 2017 – May 2018

Prime Minister Agriculture Modernization Project (PMAMP), Nepal

- Conducted farmer training sessions and field observations. Additionally, carried out a descriptive study on the adoption patterns of improved and hybrid rice varieties.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

2026 Agricultural and Applied Economics Association (AAEA) Annual Meeting, <i>Kansas City, MO</i>	Jul. 2026
15 th Annual Conference of the American Society of Health Economists (ASHEcon), <i>Minneapolis, MN</i>	Jun. 2026
North American Summer Meeting of the Econometric Society, <i>Atlanta, GA</i>	Jun. 2026
59 th Annual Meeting of the Southern Agricultural Economics Association (SAEA), <i>Louisville, KY</i>	Feb. 2026
7 th Annual Scientific Symposium, Feed the Future Innovation Lab for Nutrition, <i>Kathmandu, Nepal</i>	Dec. 2019
International Conference on Mountains in the Changing World, <i>Kathmandu, Nepal</i>	Oct. 2019

HONORS AND AWARDS

- Graduate Assistantship, Department of Agricultural, Environmental, and Development Economics, The Ohio State University.
- Graduate Assistantship, Department of Agricultural and Applied Economics, University of Georgia.
- Full Scholarship for Undergraduate Studies, Agriculture and Forestry University, Nepal.
- Undergraduate Thesis Grant, Agriculture and Forestry University, Nepal.

PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIP

- Agricultural and Applied Economics Association (AAEA)
- The Econometric Society

SERVICE

- Event Manager, Nepalese Student Association, University of Georgia, August 2020 – May 2022.
- Vice President, Nepalese Youth for Climate Action, Chitwan, January 2017 – November 2017.
- Technical Coordinator, Nepal Terai Students' Committee, January 2014 – November 2017.

SKILLS

Software	STATA, R, $\text{\LaTeX}$, Google Earth Engine
Languages	Maithili (mother tongue), Nepali (native), English (fluent) and Hindi (fluent).

REFERENCES

All at the Department of Agricultural, Environmental, and Development Economics, The Ohio State University.

Ian Sheldon
Andersons Chair of Agricultural
Marketing, Trade and Policy
Email: sheldon.1@osu.edu

Leah Bevis
Associate Professor
Email: bevis.16@osu.edu

Charity Moore
Research Assistant Professor
Email: moore.1736@osu.edu

ABSTRACTS

Does Trade Stabilize Food Prices Evenly During a Supply Shock? Evidence from India's Pulses Market

with Ian Sheldon

Developing countries often rely on trade policy to stabilize food prices during supply disruptions, yet the spatial distribution of these benefits remains poorly understood. This paper studies India's 2015–2016 pulses crisis, when consecutive domestic production shortfalls sharply raised pulses prices and triggered a surge in imports. We examine whether internal trade frictions generated uneven price relief across domestic markets. Using a district-level panel of wholesale pulses prices from 2009 to 2019 and a difference-in-differences design, we show that the import surge did not provide uniform price relief. During the crisis, each additional 100 kilometers from a major import port translated into about a 1.7 percent larger increase in pulses prices. A simple calibration suggests that imports lowered prices by about 11 percent near ports, but more than half of this relief had dissipated by the median district–port distance. The results suggest that while imports can moderate national price spikes, their stabilizing effects may be limited by incomplete internal market integration.

Effects of Unmet Son Preference on Fertility Responses and Child Health: Evidence from South Asia

with Leah Bevis

This paper provides a unified, cross-country assessment of how unmet son preference shapes fertility and child health across South Asia, leveraging quasi-random variation in firstborn sex. First, we show that son preference, activated by a firstborn daughter, reduces contraceptive use, shortens birth intervals, and reduces breastfeeding duration. These responses are pronounced in India, Nepal, and Pakistan but substantially weaker in Bangladesh. Second, we show that son preference also affects child health, with estimates concentrated in India. Second-born girls with an older sister are shorter and lighter than those with an older brother, while second-born boys with an older sister are taller and heavier. Third, we document asymmetric survival responses consistent with activated son preference: girls' survival is unaffected, but boys born after a sister are more likely to survive. Overall, the findings suggest that unmet son preference continues to shape fertility behavior and generate unequal child health outcomes.

Does Political Reservation Affect Program Implementation? Evidence from India

Solo authored

Political reservation brings disadvantaged groups into leadership positions and can change which policies are chosen and who benefits. Yet representation can improve welfare only if local leaders can also implement public programs effectively. Using administrative records on sanctioned public works and their implementation status, I examine how reserving Gram Panchayat leadership for Scheduled Castes (SCs), Other Backward Classes (OBCs), and women affects program execution across two electoral terms in Uttar Pradesh, India. I find that SC-reserved Gram Panchayats complete fewer projects and have more abandoned works than unreserved Gram Panchayats. I find similar but smaller effects for OBC reservation and almost no effect of women's reservation. These findings suggest that political inclusion alone may not ensure effective program delivery.